

CAREER PATHS

National weather services are the largest employers of meteorologists, but there are also recruitment opportunities with private-sector firms, research institutes, environmental consultancies, and utility companies.

GRADUATE To enter this profession you will need a degree in meteorology, environmental science, physics, mathematics, or a related subject.



POSTGRADUATE If you have a postgraduate degree in a related subject, you can apply for research posts. A degree will also help if you are applying for forecasting jobs.



METEOROLOGIST You will need to stay up to date with scientific and technological advances throughout your career, in areas such as climate change or mathematical modeling. You can move between a variety of roles, including research, forecasting, training, and consultancy.



FORECAST METEOROLOGIST

Prepares weather forecasts using real-time observations and data from computerized models. Forecasters also compile rolling weather reports that are shared with international weather organizations.



BROADCAST METEOROLOGIST

Presents forecasts that are televised, broadcast on radio stations, or accessed via the Internet, using maps to show aspects such as temperature and rainfall.



FORENSIC METEOROLOGIST

Usually works in a consultancy capacity, analyzing and reconstructing past weather events to help insurance companies or lawyers determine the impact of the weather conditions on a particular claim or legal case.



ENVIRONMENTAL METEOROLOGIST

Conducts research into areas including severe weather patterns, air pollution, or how weather affects the spread of disease.

SKILLS GUIDE



Effective verbal and written communication skills to explain weather forecasts clearly.



Good team-working skills to interact with groups, from the general public to technical staff.



Strong analytical skills for studying and interpreting complex meteorological data.



Excellent numerical skills for using advanced mathematical models to process weather data.



Advanced computer skills to use modeling software for simulating weather scenarios.



Attention to detail to spot unexpected weather events so that future forecasts can be revised.